

Session 2 Intro

PROPHETS & WRITINGS

Remember where you came from.

It sounds easy, doesn't it? Until... it's not?

In Session 1, we made our way through so much of the Text looking for buried treasures. Most of which reminded us of God's unending faithfulness, His fierce love, and His longing for justice—a world at shalom—the Kingdom on earth.

Can we truly remember where we came from if we don't review the finer points of the Story every once in a while?

We have so much still to learn, to experience...

As we look ahead, possibly with a healthy balance of excitement and hesitation, we have so much still to learn, to experience, but don't forget the journey that we've been on so far. We start off with a bang discussing Joshua next, so take some time to remind yourself of what you've learned about the character of God. When something seems out of character, or off, in the Text to come, we might just be meant to pay close attention to that.

In your groups or on your own, break out the whiteboard or notebook papers or collaborative Zoom screen, and review the plot so far.

If you had 20 minutes, 5 minutes, or 30 seconds—how would *you* tell the Story? What do you need to carry with you as we move onto the next portion of the Text? What do others carry with them that maybe you forgot?

How would *you* tell the Story?

You are very good.

Sabbath is the most steady of rhythms to live by.

The beast may crouch at the door, but you can master it.

Do the next right thing.

The arc of the rainbow is pointed forever upward.

Radical hospitality is a calling and a gift.

God is never out of reach.

Our God is a God who sees you.

God hears the cries of the oppressed, and we should too.

God is for the foreigner, the orphan, and the widow...

The list could go on forever.

If we think all the way back to our introductory lesson, we noted the significant differences between the Western way of thinking and the Eastern. One with quick answers or facts. The other through something more like pictures. Think through these questions, and work on polishing up this new lens we've been using, seeking to answer them with images or recurring themes we dug up in Session 1.

For instance, when I close my eyes and ask myself *What does God look like?* I see two open hands. Rough with digging and working in the dirt—a garden, perhaps—waiting to embrace me.

**I see two open
hands—waiting
to embrace me.**

What does God look like?

What does God sound like?

What does God feel like?

What does God smell like?

What does God taste like?

As you think back, don't just remember the lessons. Remember what these stories, these characters and chiasms and numbers and places, also show us something about God—something that God wants us not just to recognize, but to *remember*.

PRAYER

God,

*May we remember the Story, where we came from, as we seek to know you more.
As we gather around the Text after a hectic day, or as peace rises with the sun
above us, we ask that you meet us here.*

Continue to meet us, as you always do, right where we are.

Bless our communities as we wander together.

*Stir within us. Move through us. Challenge us. And may we hold one another up,
never to tire of this journey with You.*

Amen

THE FOUR PILLARS

BEMA Discipleship is built on four pillars; a **Four-Pillared Perspective** to help us remember **to elevate the words of God** (not ours) and help us identify the principles that we see recurring in the story of God's people.

Here are some applications for this episode echoing the ideas of the four pillars:



TEXT

Take time to review your notes or annotations in the Text from Session 1. What do you remember most? What have you memorized or studied more deeply? Go back to these places.



COMMUNITY

Think back to your group conversations, wherever they occurred. What stood out to your group from Session 1? Review in community, remembering where we came from.



DISCIPLESHIP

Is there anyone you're taking with you into these new places? Previously with Session 1, or someone new with Session 2? Who could you invite into this space with you?



WRESTLING

What questions still remain after completing Session 1? What resonates with you? Confuses you still? What are you looking forward to, or not, discussing in Session 2?



Are you a music listener?

Listen along to our BEMA Music Playlists on Spotify.

Song suggestions? Send them to bemabesorah@gmail.com.



BEMA SESSION 2



MEDITATION & PRAYER

REFLECTION, APPLICATION & IMPACT

There are three emphases that we are always thinking about in terms of application at BEMA. These may be stated explicitly at times, but often we will want you to do the work of finding ways to connect the dots to the things we are learning. Much of this is what makes the work of BEMA distinct as a ministry of Impact Campus Ministries.

CREATING A SPACE SPIRITUAL FORMATION

*True success is developing intimacy with God. In Session 1, we encountered the idea of “Creating Space for God” in our lives. We believe that **if we do our part of creating that space, God will fill it** as He desires. You’re already doing this as you dive into the Text and jump into a place to discuss. God will meet you in these places! Look for places the Holy Spirit can do work in and through you as you go about your everyday life.*

CONSIDERING CAMPUS YOUNG PEOPLE FOCUS

***We believe that young adults are shaping the future of this world.** Jesus modeled a ministry of discipling young adults, and that approach has and will work. If you are a college student who is listening, we want this material to be directly helpful to your pursuits. If you are not a college student, we want to challenge you to come alongside one and work together.*

SACRED STATION THEOLOGY OF WORK

*This isn’t only for church or Bible study; this is about what we do every day. How we do our job and how it may take advantage of or bring life to others is something God says is central to our presence in the world. Justice is very much something God cares about. Does our physical work (our 9–5 job) bring shalom or chaos? Does it exploit creation? The way we manage our employees, interact with customers or coworkers, care for our children, or create products can provide relief to others. **The work we do every day is sacred and matters!***